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NESSTAR - the data archive perspective

by

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UK Data Archive

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- The past
- Decisions... Decisions... Decisions
- Planning and preparation
- The present
- Future developments
- Benefits for everyone!

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Past considerations:

- Which datasets should be included?
- What information should be included?
- Which DDI elements should be used?
- What tools are currently available?
- What additional resources would be required?

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Decisions... Decisions... Decisions...

- Datasets for NESSTAR identified
- All variables in these datasets to be fully labelled
- Question text, interviewers instructions and ‘universe’ information to be added
- Variables to be grouped to ease navigation
- All existing documentation to be available

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Planning & preparation:

- Get acquainted with NESSTAR conversion tools
- Assess the quality of the chosen datasets
- Assess the documentation - locate questionnaires & match to data files
- Establish procedures for adding the additional information required

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The present:

- Converting existing on-line catalogue records to DDI DTD
- Enhancing existing data files
- Adding additional information into study description section of DDI
- Adding question text, and other information from questionnaires, at variable level
- Grouping variables

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Nesstar Explorer - Health Survey for England, 1997

File Edit View Bookmarks Tools Window Help

Location : http://155.245.254.82:4000/explorer/1?http%3A%2F%2Fwww.nesstar.org%2Frdf%2Fmethod=http%3A%2F%2Fwww.nesstar.org%2Frdf%2FExplorer%2FExplore&htt

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  - Relationships
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  - Attitudes to cycling
  - Major accidents
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  - Height/Weight administratio

Selected variables

Add Remove Remove All

Analysis type

Tabulate

Description Table Graphics

Household information

Variables:

- V2: Final outcome code
- V3: Number of adults in HH
- V4: Number of children in HH
- V5: Number of infants in HH
- V6: (D) Household Size
- V7: (D) Household Type
- V8: Household Tenure
- V9: Is accommodation furnished?
- V10: No. of bedrooms in household
- V11: Car available
- V12: Number of cars available
- V213: Heating/cooking appliances
- V214: Gas fired boiler for central heating or hot water
- V215: Oil fired boiler for central heating or hot water
- V216: Coal or coke boiler or stove
- V217: Wood burning stove
- V218: Gas or calor gas fire in fireplace @Iwith@I flue or chimney
- V219: Other gas or calor gas fire
- V220: Open coal fire
- V221: Gas hob or cooking rings
- V222: Gas oven
- V223: Paraffin heater
- V224: Damp in winter
- V225: Fungus in winter
- V226: Keep household pets?
- V227: Keep pets: Dog
- V228: Keep pets: Cat
- V229: Keep pets: Bird

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Future developments (1)

- Datasets assessed for NESSTAR suitability at acquisition stage
- All data routinely prepared for NESSTAR
- Question text, & other metadata, supplied in ‘NESSTAR friendly’ format

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Future developments (2)

NESSTAR suppliers to produce a ‘Guide to good practice’ which should include:

- Step-by-step instructions on the use of the conversion tools
- Details of any ‘controlled vocabularies’ for certain DDI elements
- Worked examples illustrating the use of the DDI elements in relation to NESSTAR

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Benefits to data users & data creators

- Ability to browse data and metadata from own desktop
- Ability to subset and download data and metadata
- Easier access to data resources
- Data available to a wider audience
- Greater use of data=more publicity & recognition for data provider

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Benefits to the Data Archive

- Providing information at a more detailed level than before
- Less time taken to supply data
- Seen to be taking advantage of new Web technology
- Greater use of data=more publicity & recognition for data archive=further funding=continuation of the archive

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Nesstar Explorer - Quarterly Labour Force Survey, March - May, 2000

File Edit View Bookmarks Tools Window Help

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      - Weighting
      - Cleaning Operations
  - Data Access
  - Other Study Description Mate
- Data Files Description
- Variable Description
  - Individual demographics - Pe
  - Household characteristics - F
  - Family characteristics - Persc
  - Economic activity - Person lev
  - Main job - Person level
  - Second job - Person level
  - Seeking/Not seeking work - F
    - PREFHR: Hours sought ir
    - LESPAY: Rather work sho
    - UNDEMP: Whether w'ld w
    - UNDHRS: Extra hours wis
    - UNDY981: Reason not loc
    - UNDY982: Reason not loc
    - UNDY983: Reason not loc

Selected variables

Add | Remove | Remove All

Analysis type

Tabulate

Description | Table | Graphics

Variable 134 : UNDEMP: Whether w'ld wk longer hrs at basic rate

Literal Question

"Would you prefer to work longer hours at your current basic rates- that is, not overtime or enhanced pay rates - if you were given the opportunity?"

Range of Valid Data Values

min -9

max 2

Range of Invalid Data Values

VALUE -9

VALUE -8

Universe

APPLIES IF RESPONDENT IS NOT LOOKING FOR A DIFFERENT OR ADDITIONAL JOB I.E. DIFJOB=2 OR DK

Total Responses

Summation of listed categories: 142941

Categories	Value	N	
Does not apply	-9	83927	
No answer	-8	225	
Yes	1	4556	7.7%
No	2	54233	92.3%

Summary statistics

Valid cases 58789